Fading, by degrees.

Twelve specimens, from a few letters to a flowing story. Each numbered frame is editable.
The settings below were applied by Tracking Ramp itself; the changing text is the demonstration.

01 A widening sentence

Tracking / Word / Linear / 0 to 180
Change: Letters / Auto steps / Entire story

Light had been working quietly. Each morning it crossed the room, touched the same objects, and took a little color with it. Blue softened into grey. A photograph grew pale at its edges, while the face at its center remained almost familiar.

Long text: one continuous ramp across all words.

02 Only the spaces

Tracking / Word / Linear / 0 to 850
Change: Spaces / Auto steps / Entire story

Some things fade

between the words

we leave behind.

The letters stay together; the gaps gradually open.

03 A bell in every line

Tracking / Word / Gaussian / 0 to 260
Restart: Line / Fully justified / Metrics: on

The room keeps a softer record of us. Curtains
0 57 163 260 260 163 57 0
lose their blue. Paper turns warm at the edges.
0 45 126 218 260 218 126 45 0
Every line begins again, opening at its center
0 57 163 260 260 163 57 0
and returning to quiet before the next breath.
0 57 163 260 260 163 57 0

5 pt numbers print in the gap below each text row.

04 Small, large, small

Font size / Character / Gaussian / 14 to 48 pt
Restart: Word / Change: Both / Auto steps

fading
fading
fading

The complete size curve starts again inside each word.

05 A rising memory

Baseline shift / Character / Sine / 0 to 14 pt
Restart: Never / Change: Letters / Auto steps

What stays
when light
leaves?

The glyphs rise and fall. Leading stays at 48 pt.

06 Color, then begin again

Character color / Word / Linear / Ink to Mist
Restart: Paragraph / Change: Both / Auto steps

A letter fades from black to a quiet trace. Its message remains, even as the ink grows light.

The second memory begins in darkness, then follows the first toward the edge of sight.

Each paragraph repeats the same color transition.

07 A sentence stretches

Horizontal scale / Word / Linear / 65 to 145%
Restart: Sentence / Change: Both / Auto steps

The edges grow quiet.

The hours spread thin.

The colors drift away.

Three sentences; three independent distributions.

08 Keep, then add

Skew -20 to 20 degrees; tracking 0 to 110
Use + Add property to keep skew, then add tracking.
Lower sample: rotation -12 to 12 degrees / Sine

a leaning memory

letters drift away

Two stacked properties above; separate rotation below.

09 Weight and outline

Variable weight: 800 to 100 / Word / Linear
Stroke width: 0 to 1 pt / Character / Linear

Light loses weight.

almost gone

Axis: Weight. The lower sample has a white fill.

10 A shaped measure

Line width: 58 to 100% / Centered / Smooth
Independent Gaussian contour; text tracking: 0

A room can fade without becoming empty. Light still reaches the table. A cup still marks its small circle on the wood. Only the boundaries change: the space narrows, opens, and narrows again, holding a different measure of the same familiar words. We keep reading until the edges close around the last quiet trace of a place we thought would always stay.

A longer passage flows through a changing frame width.

11 What fits the frame

Current frame / Character / Linear / 0 to 100
Same longer text; left: original / right: applied

ORIGINAL

Light leaves slowly. It crosses the room every morning, taking a little color from the curtains and a little certainty from the photograph. The objects remain in place. Their edges become less exact, until memory supplies the details

APPLIED

Light leaves slowly. It crosses the room every morning, taking a little color from the curtains and a little certainty from the photograph. The objects remain in place. Their edges become less exact, until memory

Text leaving the right frame returns to its baseline.

12 One linked story

Tracking / Frame / Linear / 0 to 140
Entire story / Change: Both / Two linked frames

FRAME 1 / 0

Fading is not always a departure. Sometimes it is a change in how a thing remains. The photograph stays on the shelf, the path stays through the grass, and the voice stays somewhere in the room. What disappears is the sharp border

FRAME 2 / 140

between presence and memory. We learn the shape again through its softer edges.

The curve assigns one value to each visible frame.

OPEN & EXPLORE

Open the INDD or IDML. In Layers, select a numbered frame on the Editable specimens layer. Run Tracking Ramp.jsx.

ADD ANOTHER PROPERTY

Set an effect, click + Add property, then choose the next property. Apply all keeps the stack; Cancel restores the starting state.

READ THE RESULTS

Auto-stabilize tries exact composition, then tracking breaks or Fixed sampling. Fixed sampling retains assignments while text reflows.

A line can change.

Weight and offset follow characters or words. Indents move complete paragraphs.
Each example keeps its saved baseline, so you can replace the curve and explore.

13 Underline weight

Character or Word / Auto steps / 0.2 to 6 pt / Change: Letters
The text stays the same size while the underline grows or forms a bell.

CHARACTER / LINEAR

the ink grows quiet

WORD / GAUSSIAN

one line holds a memory

Underlining switches on automatically. Existing underline color, style and offset are retained.

14 Underline offset

Character: Sine / Word: Linear / -2 to 12 pt / Underline weight held at 1 pt
Negative offsets move above the baseline; positive offsets move below it.

CHARACTER / SINE

the line drifts below the letters

WORD / LINEAR

the words hold another horizon

15 Paragraph indents

Paragraph / Linear / Four steps per sample / One value for each complete paragraph
Left and right: 0 to 72 pt. First line: -18 to 36 pt, with a fixed 18 pt left indent.

LEFT INDENT / 0 TO 72 PT

Light reaches the table. A little color leaves the room.

Memory keeps the edges. A familiar shape becomes less exact.

The page grows quieter. We read what remains between words.

Nothing leaves at once. The last trace takes its time.

RIGHT INDENT / 0 TO 72 PT

Light reaches the table. A little color leaves the room.

Memory keeps the edges. A familiar shape becomes less exact.

The page grows quieter. We read what remains between words.

Nothing leaves at once. The last trace takes its time.

FIRST LINE / -18 TO 36 PT

Light reaches the table. A little color leaves the room.

Memory keeps the edges. A familiar shape becomes less exact.

The page grows quieter. We read what remains between words.

Nothing leaves at once. The last trace takes its time.

WHOLE PARAGRAPHS

A partial selection includes each paragraph it touches. Indents can also affect a continuation in another frame or overset.

REPLACE & RESTORE

Cancel restores the starting formatting. Reapplying restores old targets before assigning new values. Underline automatic values are preserved.

ONE CURVE PER SCOPE

Indent properties use Paragraph, Both and Never restart. Curves run across the selected paragraphs without splitting their formatting.

A changing measure.

One width for each fitted line. The remaining space becomes equal left and right indents.
Extra paragraph breaks are managed by the script; original paragraph boundaries are retained.

16 A longer bell

Line length / Gaussian / 45 to 100% of usable frame width / Auto steps
Values per: Line / Change: Both / Restart: Never / Current frame

The light fades slowly enough that we almost miss the change. A curtain gives up its blue, a table loses the hard edge of its shadow, and the afternoon makes a softer shape around the room. Nothing has gone, yet everything has moved a little further into memory. We read the same words again and find more space around them. The measure opens toward the middle, holding a longer breath, then draws inward as the passage reaches its end.

A photograph remains beside the window. Its colors have grown quiet, but the face is still there. Fading can be a way of staying: less exact, less certain, and still recognizable. What remains asks us to look more slowly, until the last lines gather around a small and familiar trace.

17 A shorter ramp

Line length / Linear / 40 to 100% of usable frame width / Auto steps
Wider rows take more words. These are available widths, not exact ink lengths.

A trace remains. The color leaves first, then the sharp edges of the room. What stays is a rhythm: a few words held close, a longer sentence opening into light, and the quiet after it.

TRY A DIFFERENT CURVE

Select specimen 16 or 17. Choose Line length - centered, set Min/Max percentages, then change the curve or steps.

REPLACE & RESTORE

Replace restores owned word gaps before refitting. Cancel restores the starting document. Apply keeps one Undo action.

ONE RECTANGULAR FRAME

Use one unthreaded, rectangular frame with one column. Paragraph-aware styles may repeat on the new line paragraphs.